

1 **HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES - FLOOR VERSION**

2 STATE OF OKLAHOMA

3 2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

4 COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE
5 FOR ENGROSSED
6 SENATE BILL NO. 1501

By: Jech and Bullard of the
Senate

and

Moore of the House

11 COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE

12 An Act relating to medical marijuana; amending
13 Section 3, Chapter 328, O.S.L. 2022, as last amended
14 by Section 1, Chapter 389, O.S.L. 2025 (63 O.S. Supp.
15 2025, Section 427.14b), which relates to credentials
16 required for employees to work in licensed medical
17 marijuana business; allowing the Oklahoma Medical
18 Marijuana Authority to approve certain third-party
19 vendor; requiring Authority to approve or deny vendor
20 within certain time period; providing certain
21 requirements for vendors; requiring specific hours of
22 training for certain subjects; updating statutory
23 language; providing an effective date; and declaring
24 an emergency.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. AMENDATORY Section 3, Chapter 328, O.S.L.
2022, as last amended by Section 1, Chapter 389, O.S.L. 2025 (63
O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 427.14b), is amended to read as follows:

1 Section 427.14b. A. Beginning January 1, 2024, the Oklahoma
2 Medical Marijuana Authority shall require employees of a medical
3 marijuana business licensee to apply for and receive a credential
4 authorizing the employee to work in a licensed medical marijuana
5 business.

6 B. The Authority may contract with one or more third-party
7 vendors to provide the credentialing services necessary to carry out
8 the provisions of this section.

9 C. The Authority shall determine the services to be provided by
10 such third-party vendor and shall establish costs and prices. If
11 contracted for credentialing services, a third-party vendor shall on
12 behalf of the Authority conduct the background checks and verify
13 eligibility for any employees of a medical marijuana business
14 license holder to obtain a credential.

15 D. Upon successful completion of the national fingerprint-based
16 background check conducted by the Oklahoma State Bureau of
17 Investigation within thirty (30) days prior to the application,
18 completion of the educational training required pursuant to the
19 provisions of this section, and verification of eligibility for an
20 employee, the Authority shall issue a credential to the employee.
21 The applicant shall submit proof of completion of the required
22 educational training in the credential application, and the results
23 of background checks and verifications shall be provided to the
24 Authority by the third-party vendor.

1 E. Beginning January 1, 2027, in order to receive an employee
2 credential, all employees of a licensed medical marijuana business
3 shall annually complete an educational training course ~~provided by~~
4 ~~or~~ approved by the Authority. The employee shall submit proof of
5 completion of the required educational training in order to receive
6 an employee credential. Such training may include an overview of
7 state statutes and administrative rules, patient privacy
8 requirements, and the safe handling and storage of medical
9 marijuana.

10 F. If the third-party vendor determines that an employee of a
11 medical marijuana business holder does not meet the minimum
12 statutory requirements for a credential, the applicant or employee
13 shall have no recourse against the third-party vendor but may appeal
14 such adverse determination to the Authority.

15 G. The third-party vendor shall not be civilly liable to an
16 applicant, licensee, or employee of a licensee for any acts taken in
17 good-faith compliance with the provisions of Section 420 et seq. of
18 this title and the Oklahoma Medical Marijuana and Patient Protection
19 Act and the rules promulgated by the Oklahoma Medical Marijuana
20 Authority.

21 H. 1. The Authority shall review the medical marijuana
22 credential application; approve, reject, or deny the application;
23 and send the approval, rejection, or denial letter to the applicant
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1 by the same method in which the application was submitted to the
2 Authority.

3 2. Each approved applicant shall be issued a credential, which
4 shall act as proof of his or her approved status, to be worn or
5 displayed during the hours of work of the employee. Rejection and
6 denial letters shall provide a reason for the rejection or denial.
7 Applications may only be rejected or denied for failure to meet the
8 standards set forth in the provisions of the Oklahoma Medical
9 Marijuana and Patient Protection Act or rules promulgated by the
10 Executive Director of the Authority. If an application is rejected
11 for failure to provide required information, the applicant shall
12 have thirty (30) days to submit the required information for
13 reconsideration. Unless the Authority determines otherwise, an
14 application that has been resubmitted but is still incomplete or
15 contains errors that are not clerical or typographical in nature
16 shall be denied.

17 I. The Authority may approve any third-party vendor meeting the
18 requirements of subsection J of this section to provide the
19 educational training course necessary to carry out the provisions of
20 subsection E of this section. The Authority shall have thirty (30)
21 days to approve or deny any application of a vendor to provide such
22 educational training.

23 J. To be approved by the Authority, the vendor shall:
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1 1. Be an association related to the medical marijuana industry
2 in this state with an IRS Letter 947 determining 509(a)(2) public
3 charity status under Section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code
4 of 1986, as amended, with an effective date of exemption prior to
5 January 1, 2026; and

6 2. Provide an educational training course plan that includes an
7 overview of state statutes and administrative rules, patient privacy
8 requirements, and the safe handling and storage of medical
9 marijuana. The educational training shall provide a minimum of one
10 (1) hour of in-person training for each subject addressed in the
11 educational training course plan.

12 K. The Executive Director of the Authority may promulgate rules
13 to implement the provisions of this section.

14 SECTION 2. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

15 SECTION 3. It being immediately necessary for the preservation
16 of the public peace, health or safety, an emergency is hereby
17 declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and
18 be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

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20 COMMITTEE REPORT BY: COMMITTEE ON HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES
21 OVERSIGHT, dated 04/16/2026 - DO PASS, As Amended.
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